

Figure 3: Gedit opens up all the files customisable in the Quickly project

quickly edit

This involves event driven programming where a block of Python code is written for each 'signal'. Signals for each component can be activated from within the signals tab in Glade. When the coding for this application is complete, you can run the application with the following command:

quickly run

When everything is up and running fine, you can save and commit the work in Bazaar version control:

quickly save "commit message"

Towards the end of software development, you might consider debugging your application with the help of a utility provided by Quickly, which is known as *windbg* (Figure 4). It works like any other debugging application that can step through code, and provide information about variables and exceptions that occur within the application. This Python debugging application can be launched with the following debugging command:

quickly debug

You could also choose to share your application's code on Launchpad so that more collaborators can work and submit changes to your application. This can be done with the help of the *quickly share* and *quickly release* commands, but you need a Launchpad account for that. Launchpad is a project hosting tool that is used by Ubuntu and innumerable other projects to collaborate on their products.

Licensing and packaging

Before releasing the finished application for distribution to others, it is important to mention the licence under which the application is being distributed. As of now, by default, Quickly assumes this to be GPL3. To generate a licence, use the following licence command:

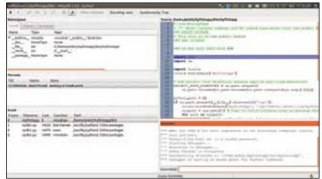


Figure 4: The *windbg* debugging window

quickly license

This command adds the licence at the beginning of every file in the form of a comment header. It only works for the BSD, GPL-2, GPL-3, LGPL-2 and LGPL-3 licences. If any other licences are to be used, they are to be added in the form of a COPYING file, which will add it to each file generated by the Quickly workflow.

The *Desktop* file and *Setup.py* file can now be edited to add information specific to the application and the developer. This includes the category, type and icon of the application in the *Desktop* file, while the *Setup.py* file includes the author's contact details and description of the application.

When everything is ready, you should be all set to start packaging your application in the form of a *deb* package so that it can be distributed and installed easily on any Ubuntu system:

quickly package

This will generate a *deb* package and a zip of the source code in the parent directory of the Quickly project folder. This *deb* can then be installed on your Ubuntu system (or any other Ubuntu system), and you will be able to see that it integrates into the dash properly as is the case with any other Ubuntu application. To distribute your app more easily, you might prefer using a Personal Package Archive or maybe even publish your application to the Ubuntu Software Center (USC). Every application that is submitted to the USC goes through an approval process defined by Canonical, and it could take a couple of days before the application is finally visible online.

Since you've now had a brief introduction to how the Quickly application development cycle works, you might have already noticed that the commands and work needed at each step are almost zero, and the majority of the work is done for the developer by preconfigured tools. I hope that as the project progresses, more options and templates will be made available. 

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